

Unit 2



Hongmei Pang

*He does it with a better grace, but I do it more
natural.*

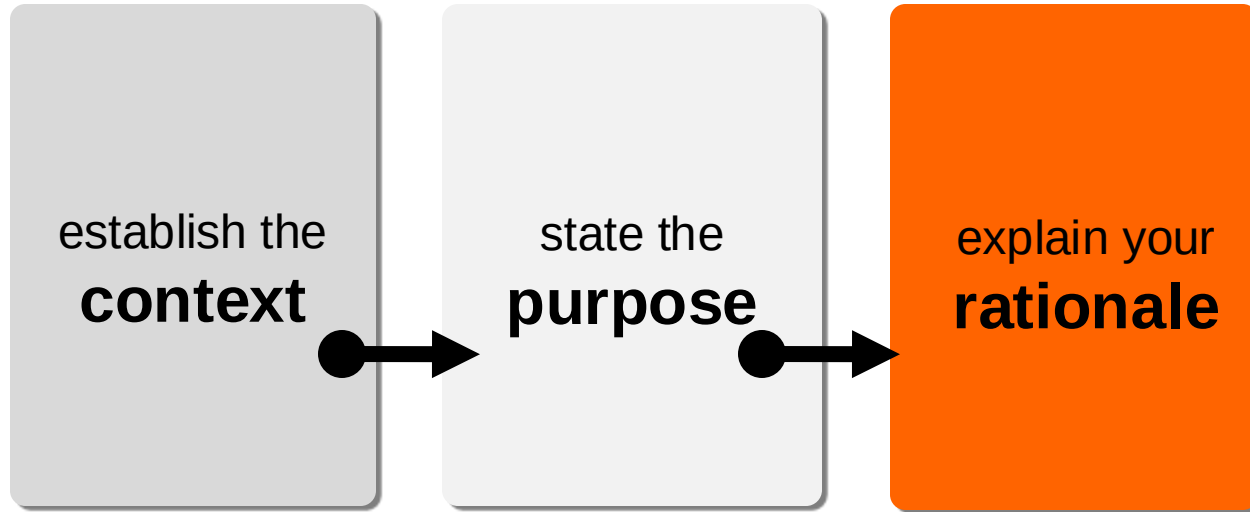
– Shakespeare
Twelfth Night
Act II, scene iii

Learning objectives

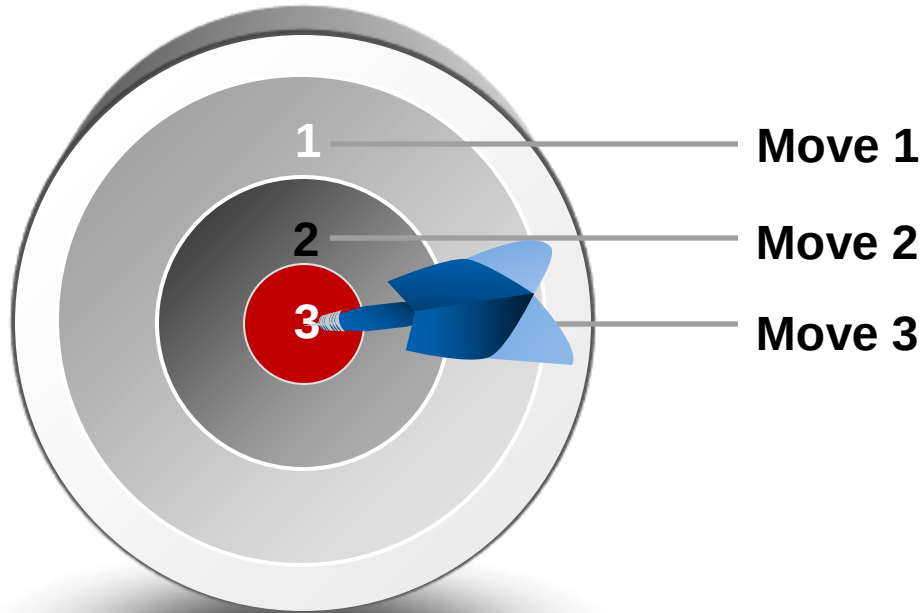


- CARS model
- 3 ways to present RQs
- Language patterns
- Collocation

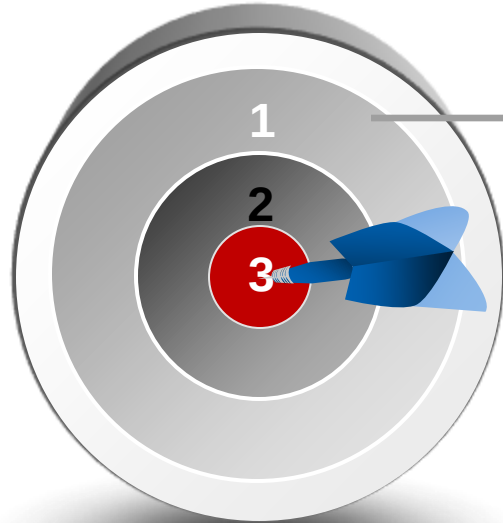
Function of Introduction



CARS Model: **C**reating **a** **R**esearch **S**pace



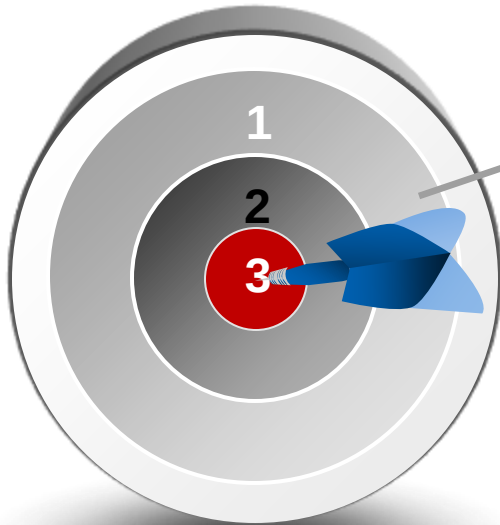
CARS Model: Move 1



Establishing a research territory

- by showing that the general **research area** is important, central, interesting, problematic, or relevant in some way. (optional)
- by introducing and reviewing items of **previous research** in the area. (obligatory)

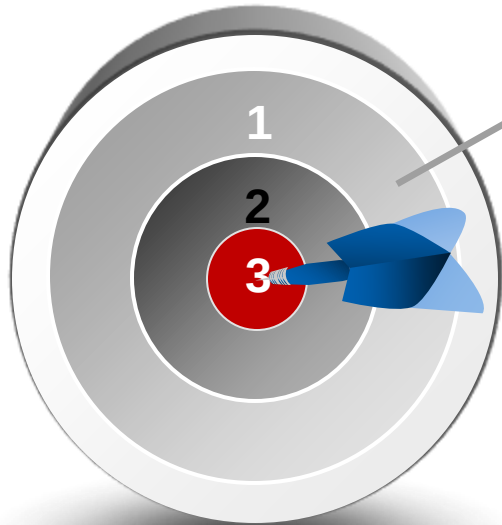
CARS Model: Move 2



Establishing the motivation for the study

➤ by indicating a **gap** in the previous research, raising a question about it, or extending previous knowledge in some way. (obligatory)

CARS Model: Move 3

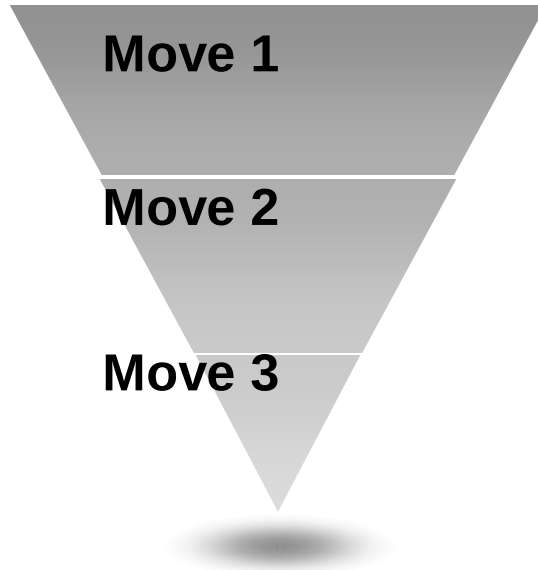


Making an offer to fill the gap

- by outlining **purposes** or stating the nature and value of the present research. (obligatory)
- by announcing principal **findings**. (optional)
- by indicating the **structure** of the RP. (optional)

Introduction

CARS Model: **C**reating **a** **R**esearch **S**pace



Move 1

Establish a **territory** = previous research

Move 2

Indicate a **gap**

Move 3

State the **purpose**



**Natural
&
Rational
response**

Introduction

The findings were derived from a close analysis of 433 empirical RAs from high-impact English- language journals in 39 disciplines in the fields of engineering, applied sciences, social sciences and the humanities.

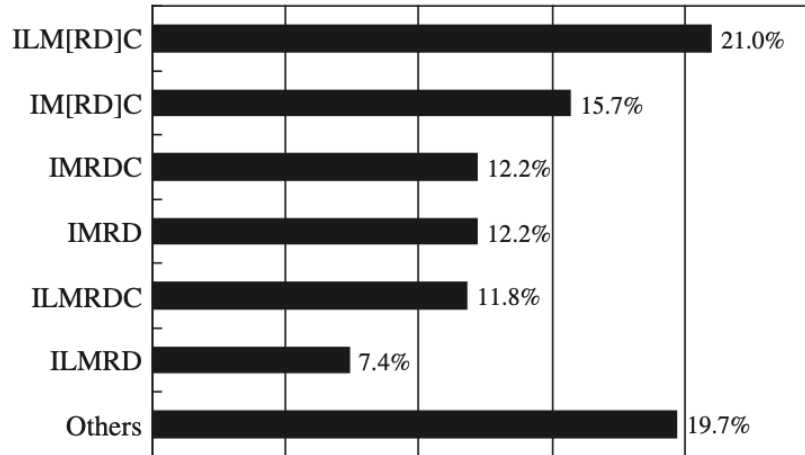


Fig. 1. The macro-structural patterns of empirical RAs.

Literature review: 40.2%

Adolescents' Psychosocial Well-being One Year After the Outbreak of the COVID-19 Pandemic in Norway

On 11 March 2020, the World Health Organization declared the COVID-19 outbreak a pandemic. Since then, drastic measures to prevent the spread of the pandemic have been implemented worldwide. **The imposed restrictions**, such as school closures, physical distancing and restrictions on recreational activities, **raise concerns about adolescents' well-being**. Knowledge about psychosocial consequences of the COVID-19 pandemic is rapidly accumulating; **however, there is a scarcity of large-scale, population-based, repeated cross-sectional studies** providing comprehensive assessments of psychosocial factors before and during the pandemic. Moreover, **even though** some information is available about adolescents' psychosocial well-being during the initial months of the pandemic, **the long-term effects are less known**. **To address this issue, we use** nationwide Norwegian data from 227,258 adolescents before and one year into the pandemic. **By applying multilevel societal growth curves** that enable us to disentangle the sudden changes during the pandemic from long-term time trends, **we examine** (1) changes in psychosocial outcomes during the pandemic, (2) whether disadvantaged groups are particularly vulnerable to these changes and (3) whether these changes vary with geographical variations in infection rates and restrictions.

von Soest, T., Kozák, M., Rodríguez-Cano, R., Fluit, D. H., Cortés-García, L., Ulset, V. S., Haghighi, E. F., & Bakken, A. (2022). Adolescents' psychosocial well-being one year after the outbreak of the COVID-19 pandemic in Norway. *Nature human behaviour*, 6(2), 217–228.

Lead By
Example

Move 1:
Establishing a
research territory

Move 2:
Establishing a niche
✓ Indicating **a gap**
✓ Raising a **question**

Move 3:
Presenting **the research questions**

- What was I studying?
- Why was it an important question?
- What did we know about it before I did this study?
- How will this study advance our knowledge?



general statements

include those providing facts as well as broad statements made about a topic that are usually true

statistics

can be effective and generate reader interest

definitions

avoid ambiguity

Literature Review

Showing importance and rationale :

- The increasing interest in...has heightened the need for...
- Recently, there has been growing interest in ...
- The possibility of ... had generated wide interest in...
- The development of ... has led to the hope that...
- The ... has become a favorite for analysis...
- Knowledge of ... has a great importance for...
- The study of ... become an important aspect of ...
- A central issue in ... is ...
- The ... has been extensively studied in recent years.
- Many investigators have recently turned to ...
- The relationship between ... has been investigated by many researchers.
- Many recent studies have focused on...
- The rationale for the selection of ... as the focus of the study is two-fold.

7 types of research gaps

Evidence gap	Little or no evidence to address the research problem.
Knowledge gap	Desired research findings do not exist.
Practical-Knowledge gap	Professional behavior or practices deviate from research findings or are not covered by the research.
Methodological gap	A variation of research methods is necessary to generate new insights or to avoid ambiguous findings.
Empirical gap	Research findings need to be evaluated or empirically verified.
Theoretical gap	Theory should be applied to certain research issues to generate new insights; lack of theoretical knowledge may lead to a gap in research.
Population gap	Type of research gap that deals with a population which is not adequately represented or under-researched in the prior research (Eg., gender, age, race).

Coming to move 2

However, little information..

little attention...

little work...

little data

little research

or few studies

few investigations...

few researchers...

few attempts...

focused on
attempted to
investigated
studied

Sentence pattern

Previous research (studies, records) has (have)
failed to consider
ignored
misinterpreted
neglected to
overestimated, underestimated

thus, these previous results are inconclusive/ misleading/
unsatisfactory/questionable/controversial.

Uncertainties (discrepancies) still exist ...

Sentence pattern

However, data is still scarce.

rare.

less accurate.

We need to /aim to/ have to provide more data.

Further studies are still necessary/ essential...

Contrast	Quantity	Verbs	Adjectives
albeit	few	challenge	difficult
although	handful	disregard	dubious
but	less	exclude	elusive
howbeit	little	fail	inadequate
however	no	hinder	incomplete
nevertheless	none	ignore	inconclusive
notwithstanding	not	lack	inefficacious
unfortunately		limit	ineffective
whereas		misinterpret	inefficient
yet		neglect	questionable
		obviate	scarce
		omit	uncertain
		overlook	unclear
		prevent	unconvincing
		question	unproductive
		restrict	unreliable
			unsatisfactory

negative stance VS contrastive statement

- Prior research has focused on A, rather than on B...
- Prior research into A can be useful but to counterbalance X, it is important to consider B...
- These studies have emphasized A, as opposed to B...
- While prior studies have examined A, it may be preferable to contemplate the impact of B...
- After consideration of A, it is important to also recognize B...
- The study of A has been exhaustive, but changing circumstances related to X support the need for examining or revisiting B...
- Although considerable research has been devoted to A, less attention has been paid to B...
- Earlier research offers insight into the need for A, though consideration of B is also helpful...

Research Questions

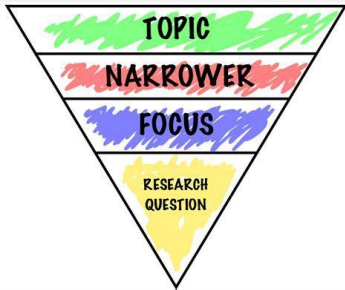
What is a research question?

A research question is a **clear, focused, concise, complex and arguable** question around which you center your research.

Research Questions

- Research questions are essential to the research process.
- Research questions help writers focus their research by providing a path through the research and writing process.
- The specificity of a well-developed research question helps writers avoid the “all-about” paper and work toward supporting a specific, arguable thesis.

Research Questions



Steps to developing a research question:

- **Choose an interesting general topic.**
Choose a broad topic about which you genuinely would like to know more. An example of a general topic might be “Hollywood films of the 1980s.”
- **Do some preliminary research on your general topic.**
See what’s already been done and narrow your focus.
- **Consider your audience.**
Keep your audience in mind.

Topic

Research question

Body image and Social media

- How are the teenage girls' views of their body affected by social media?

Research problem

The teachers at school X do not have the skills to recognize or properly guide gifted children in the classroom.

Under-30s increasingly engage in the “gig economy” instead of traditional full-time employment, but we know little about young people’s experiences of this type of work.

Research questions

- What practical techniques can teachers at school X use to better identify and guide gifted children?
- What are the main factors that influence young people’s decisions to engage in the gig economy?
- What do workers perceive as its advantages and disadvantages?
- What effect do age and education level have on how people experience this type of work?

Topic

Research Questions

Aims

What is plagiarism?

What leads students to plagiarise or stop plagiarising?

How effective or efficient are university sanctions/policies on plagiarism?

What are students' understandings of, and attitudes towards, plagiarism

Description

Explanation

Evaluation

Exploration



Research Questions

Characteristics of a strong research question



- **Focused** on a single problem or issue
- **Researchable** using primary and/or secondary sources
- **Specific** enough to answer thoroughly
- **Feasible** to answer within the timeframe and practical constraints
- **Complex** enough to develop the answer over the space of a paper or thesis
- **Relevant** to your field of study and/or society more broadly
- **Original** has not already been answered

Research Questions

Pair 1

- Has there been an increase in homelessness in XXX in the past ten years?
- How have economic and political factors affected patterns of homelessness in X XX over the past ten years?

Avoid closed *yes/no* questions

Research Questions

Pair 2

- Which one is a better policy, X or Y?
- How effective are X and Y policies at reducing rates of Z?

Avoid subjective value judgement.
Use terms with more measurable definitions.

Research Questions

Pair 3

- What effect does social media have on people's minds?
- What effect does daily use of Douyin have on the attention span of under-16s?

Avoid vague language and broad ideas.
Uses specific, well-defined concepts.

Research Questions

Pair 4

- What should the government do about low garbage sorting rate?
- What are the most effective communication strategies for encouraging garbage sorting?

Avoiding asking for a conclusive solution, policy, or course of action.
Research is about informing, not instructing.

Research Questions

3 ways to present research questions

- Thesis statement
- Question
- Hypothesis

Indicating purposes

- The aim of the present paper is to give...
- This paper reports on the results obtained...
- In this paper we give preliminary results for...
- The main purpose of the experiment reported here is to ...
- This study was designed to evaluate...
- The present work extends the use of ...
- We now report the interaction between...
- The primary focus of this paper is on...
- The aim of this investigation is to test...
- It is the purpose of the present paper to provide...

Secondary aims or features (Optional):

- In addition, an effort is made to ...
- Additionally, ...
- A secondary aim of the present paper is to...
- A further reason for...

Stating Value (Optional):

- In this way, we offer a solution to a long-standing problem in...
- It is hoped that this study will revive interest in a long-neglected feature of...
- The information presented should be useful to...

Outlining the structure of the text (Optional):

- The plan of this paper is as follows.
- Section II describes ...
- In Section III a theoretical model is constructed which is designed to...
- ... are then tested in Section IV.
- Finally, Section V offers some suggestions for the modification of the current ...

Sentence pattern

Section 1 **defines** the notion of robustness, and **argues for** its importance.

Section 2 **gives** the background of the problem which includes xxx

Section 2 **discusses** some problems with and approaches to...

Section 2 **explains** how flexibility can be expressed in terms of ...

Section 3 **describes** a new measure of xx.

Section 3 **demonstrates** the use of xxx theory in the analysis of xxx.

Section 3 **is a fine description** of fuzzy formulation of human decision.

Section 3 and 4 **show** experimental studies for verifying the proposed model.

Section 4 **gives** a specific example of xxx.

Sentence pattern

Section 4 **is** the experimental study to make a fuzzy model of memory process.

Section 4 **contains** a discussion of the implication of the results of Section 3.

Section 4 **applies** this fuzzy measure to the analysis of xx.

Section 5 **presents** the primary results of the paper: a fuzzy set model ..

Section 6 **illustrates** the model with an example.

Various ways of justification and the reasons for their choice are **discussed** very briefly in Section 2.

In Section 2 we shall **list** a collection of basic assumptions ...

In Section 2 of this paper, we **present** representation and uniqueness ...

In Section 3, we **describe** the preliminary results of an empirical study ...



Social and Cultural Contexts in Conversion to Christianity among Chinese American College Students

Brian Hall

One of the important questions that Fenggang Yang (1998) raises in his breakthrough work on the subject of Chinese conversion to evangelical Christianity is that of the role social and cultural contexts play in the conversion process. Although sociologists of religion have done much to make better sense of the phenomenon of conversion (see, for example, Lofland and Stark 1965; Heirich 1977; Straus 1979; Snow and Machalek 1984), the emphasis has been primarily on the conversion "of single individuals" (Bainbridge 1992:2), on "what kind of individuals convert and the processes whereby individuals get recruited" (Yang 1998:241). The problem with this individualistic approach is that it fails to pay "attention to the larger social and cultural contexts within which these individuals change their religion" and is "inadequate to understand the phenomenon of convert groups" (Yang 1998:241-242). Although the process of conversion may be an individual experience, it is "produced by many stages of transmission, in the context of particular societies and their traditions" (Morrison 1992:5). While scholars may be willing to accept the argument that social and cultural factors are "extremely important in the conversion process," the exact role that such factors play is "not yet understood" in such a way that would permit precise elucidation" (Rambo 1982:147).

CARS
model



This is especially so in the case of the Chinese in America. While there are many indicators that Christianity is becoming increasingly popular among the Chinese in America (see Lee 2000; Fong 1999; Yang 1999), the exact reasons for this transformation are relatively unknown. Even more fascinating is the attraction to Christianity among Chinese American college students. Ch'ien (2000:68) notes that Chinese and other Asian American young people have been joining college Christian groups "in eye-opening numbers," leading Busto (1996:134) to comment that such students have "become central players in American evangelical Christianity.....Unfortunately, much of the current understanding regarding this phenomenon "remains for the most part anecdotal" (Busto 1996:134) as research addressing these changes among the Chinese American student population has received only scant attention in sociology of religion and Asian American studies literature (see Warner 1998; Yoo 1996).

In this article I develop a preliminary model that can be used to help understand the social and cultural forces that may be drawing Chinese American young people to Christianity...

CARS
model

General
↓
Specific
population

transition

Research
Question

The Tyranny of Numbers

Alwyn Young

Sloan School of management, MIT

Introduction

This is a fairly boring and tedious paper, and is intentionally so. This paper **provides no new interpretations** of the East Asian experience **to interest the historian**, **derives no new theoretical implications** of the forces behind the East Asian growth process **to motivate the theorist**, and **draws no new policy implications** from the subtleties of East Asian government intervention **to excite the policy activist**. Instead, this paper concentrates its energies on **providing a careful analysis** of the historical patterns of output growth, factor accumulation, and productivity growth in the newly industrializing countries of East Asia.

Reading research papers



1. Introduction:

- **Importance of the topic:** The rising incidence of plagiarism has sparked growing concern and led to increased research on its various aspects.
- **Research gap:** There is a lack of research on institutional policies on plagiarism in the Chinese context.
- **Research purpose:** This paper examines the publicly available plagiarism policies of eight major universities of foreign studies in China.
- **Value:** We hope that the study can provide a window to understanding how the issue of plagiarism is problematized, explained, and responded to in Chinese universities, and yield findings that suggest ways in which institutional policies can be revised and improved for greater relevance and effectiveness.

2. Previous research (literature review):

Multifaceted Nature of Plagiarism:(para.3)

- Various disciplines
- Various perspectives
- Culture
- Developmental issue
- Disciplinary Differences
- Electronic media
- Institutional policies

Chinese Students and Teachers:(para.4)

- Mixed findings
- Cultural factors: more tolerant
- Knowledge and attitudes: punitive attitudes towards plagiarism
- Relationship with knowledge: motivation

Institutional Approaches and Discourses:(para.5-8)

- Institutional Role: responsibility to educate and develop effective policies
- Policy Features: definitions, examples, explanations, educational approaches, and sanctions
- Three Approaches:
 - Punitive
 - Self-regulative
 - Educative
- Three Discourses:
 - Moralist
 - Regulatory
 - Academic writing

Text-Matching Software:(para.9-10)

- Widespread use
- Effectiveness as a deterrent
- Limitations and concerns
- Integration with education

The Chinese Context:(para.11-12)

- Regulatory developments
- Existing research
- Research gaps

Research Questions

3. Methodology

- Data collection

- Selection of eight major universities in China
- Collection of plagiarism policy documents from official websites

- Data analysis

- Document analysis focusing on location, structure, and content
- Development and iterative refinement of a coding scheme
- Identification of key themes and patterns

4. Findings

4.1. Location

- Availability of documents on universities' official websites, primarily in graduate school sections

4.2. Structure

- Common sections: general statements, description of academic misconduct, procedures and sanctions

4.3. Content

- Predominance of punitive and regulatory approaches and discourses
- Limited understanding of plagiarism
- Lack of proactive educational measures
- Use of text-matching software primarily for detection

5. Discussion

A. Common themes and problems of the institutional policies

- Predominance of the punitive and regulatory approaches rather than the educative approach
- Limited knowledge of plagiarism among policy authors
- Power relations of the oversight bodies with the school administration may reduce consistency and transparency
- The text-matching software at the heart of the procedure to deal with plagiarism is mainly used to detect plagiarism

B. Implications for second language student writers

- Inadequate institutional policies may partly explain the difficulties Chinese international students face with the Anglo-American concept of plagiarism

6. Conclusion

A. Main conclusion

- Chinese universities' plagiarism policies exhibit distinctive characteristics and are not aligned with the growing consensus on the need for educative approaches

B. Limitation and future research directions

- Comparing policies across different types of universities
- Conducting interviews with stakeholders
- Tracking policy changes over time



Activity

Work on the collocation task.



Plagiarism

参与抄袭/抄袭

Commit plagiarism

Engage in plagiarism

处理/解决/遏制

Tackle plagiarism

Deal with plagiarism

Combat plagiarism

Curb plagiarism

维护学术诚信

uphold academic integrity

经济发达的大都市
欠发达的内陆省份

economically developed metropolis
less developed interior provinces

Learning achievements

- ✓ CARS model
- ✓ 3 ways to present RQs
- ✓ Language patterns
- ✓ Collocation

